

INTERNSHIP POLICY

Policy Type: Organizational Policy

Applicable To: All Interns

Policy Owner: BSmile The Mind Studio

Effective Date: 01/08/2026

Version: 1.0

Review Frequency: As required by the organization

1. PURPOSE

The Internship Programme at BSmile The Mind Studio is designed to provide interns with structured professional exposure to the functioning of a mental health organization.

The programme provides supervised opportunities to develop professional competencies relevant to the intern's area of study or assigned role, including professional communication, documentation, client interaction, organizational processes, teamwork, and workplace conduct.

The internship is intended to provide practical exposure while maintaining appropriate professional, ethical, and confidentiality standards applicable to the organization's work.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all interns engaged by BSmile The Mind Studio, irrespective of their academic discipline, educational institution, internship duration, or assigned department.

Where an internship requires additional requirements based on the intern's academic programme, professional discipline, or specific assignment, such requirements may be communicated separately and shall be read together with this policy.

3. ELIGIBILITY

Internship opportunities may be offered to students or individuals who meet the educational, professional, or other requirements determined by BSmile The Mind Studio for the specific internship position.

The organization reserves the right to determine eligibility based on:

- Academic background.
- Relevant skills and competencies.

- Internship requirements.
- Availability of suitable supervisory resources.
- Organizational requirements.
- Any additional criteria established for a specific internship programme.

4. INTERNSHIP DURATION

The duration of the internship will be determined by BSmile The Mind Studio based on the requirements of the internship programme and the applicable academic or institutional requirements.

The internship period, commencement date, and completion date will be communicated to the intern before the commencement of the internship.

Any extension or modification of the internship period will require approval from the organization.

5. OBJECTIVES OF THE INTERNSHIP

The internship programme is intended to provide interns with structured professional exposure to:

- The functioning of a mental health organization.
- Professional workplace practices.
- Client interaction and communication, where applicable to the assigned role.
- Documentation and reporting procedures.
- Organizational coordination and teamwork.
- Multidisciplinary professional interaction, where applicable.
- Ethical and professional standards.
- Confidentiality and appropriate professional boundaries.
- Responsibilities associated with the intern's assigned role.

The nature and extent of exposure provided to each intern may vary according to the intern's academic background, assigned responsibilities, demonstrated capability, performance, and organizational requirements.

6. INTERNSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES

Interns may be assigned responsibilities relevant to their area of study, assigned role, and the operational requirements of BSmile The Mind Studio.

Depending on the nature of the internship, responsibilities may include:

- Assisting with assigned administrative or operational activities.
- Assisting with client-related coordination where appropriate.
- Preparing and maintaining assigned documentation.
- Preparing reports and maintaining records as directed.
- Assisting relevant professional teams with assigned activities.
- Participating in meetings, discussions, presentations, or other designated activities.
- Supporting assigned projects or organizational initiatives.
- Conducting Initial Assessments and completing Assessment documentation.
- Carrying out other responsibilities reasonably assigned by the Internship Supervisor.

6.1 Performance-Based Responsibilities

Responsibilities will not necessarily be identical for all interns.

The level and nature of responsibility assigned to an intern will be determined based on:

- Demonstrated capability.
- Quality and accuracy of work.
- Professional conduct.
- Reliability and punctuality.
- Ability to follow instructions.
- Ability to work independently where appropriate.
- Response to feedback.
- Overall performance.

An intern may initially be assigned limited or closely supervised responsibilities. Additional responsibilities may be assigned progressively when the intern demonstrates the required level of competence and reliability.

The organization reserves the right to modify, increase, reduce, or reassign responsibilities based on the intern's performance and operational requirements.

7. SUPERVISION AND REPORTING

Each intern will be assigned an Internship Supervisor or designated reporting authority.

The intern is expected to:

- Report to the assigned supervisor as instructed.
- Complete assigned responsibilities within the specified timelines.
- Maintain regular communication regarding assigned work.
- Submit daily task reports, weekly reports, or other documentation as required.
- Seek clarification or professional guidance when required.
- Follow reasonable instructions provided by the supervisor or authorized members of the organization.
- Report any difficulty, concern, or issue affecting assigned responsibilities in a timely manner.
- Requests for leave should also be communicated with their supervisor and except for emergency/sick leaves, intern should have prior approval from the supervising authority.

The Internship Supervisor will provide appropriate direction, supervision, and performance feedback based on the intern's responsibilities.

8. CLINICAL AND PROFESSIONAL EXPOSURE

Where relevant to the internship role, interns may be provided supervised exposure to:

- Professional case discussions.
- Multidisciplinary coordination.
- Client intake and assessment procedures.
- Documentation and reporting practices.

- Treatment planning processes.
- Professional communication.
- Ethical practices within mental health services.
- Organizational procedures related to client services.

Such exposure will be provided only to the extent considered appropriate by the organization and the supervising professional.

Interns shall not independently undertake clinical, therapeutic, diagnostic, or other professional responsibilities that require a specific professional qualification, registration, or authorization.

9. CLINIC TIMINGS AND ATTENDANCE

The clinic operates **Monday to Saturday, from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM.**

Intern attendance requirements may vary depending on:

- Assigned responsibilities.
- Internship requirements.
- Scheduled activities.
- Supervisory requirements.
- Operational requirements of the organization.

Standard Timings for Interns are from 10AM-4PM. Interns may be required to attend during all or part of the clinic's operating hours, as required.

The expected schedule will be communicated by the Internship Supervisor or designated authority.

Regular attendance and punctuality are mandatory and will form part of the intern's overall performance assessment.

10. LEAVE AND ABSENCE

- Regular attendance is expected throughout the internship period.
- Leave must be communicated to and approved by the Internship Supervisor in advance, except where circumstances make prior communication impractical.

- Medical leave may be subject to appropriate supporting documentation where required.
- Unapproved absence may be recorded as a violation of internship requirements.
- Repeated absence or persistent punctuality issues may negatively affect the intern's performance evaluation and eligibility for successful completion of the internship.
- The organization reserves the right to review the internship status of an intern in cases of prolonged or repeated absence.

11. PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

All interns are expected to maintain professional conduct throughout the internship.

Interns shall:

- Maintain professionalism in all interactions.
- Treat clients, supervisors, psychologists, colleagues, and other staff members with respect.
- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
- Follow organizational policies, procedures, and instructions.
- Maintain punctuality and workplace discipline.
- Communicate professionally and respectfully.
- Take reasonable responsibility for assigned work.
- Respond appropriately to feedback and supervision.
- Avoid conduct that may adversely affect clients, staff members, or the reputation of BSmile The Mind Studio.
- Uphold the ethical principles applicable to their area of study and professional practice.

12. DRESS CODE

Interns are required to maintain a neat and professional appearance while attending the organization.

Appropriate professional attire may include:

- Indian formal wear.
- Western formal wear.
- Other neat and professionally appropriate attire suitable for a mental health workplace.

The organization may provide additional dress requirements where necessary for specific activities or responsibilities.

13. CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA PROTECTION

Due to the sensitive nature of mental health services, interns may have access to confidential client, clinical, employee, operational, or organizational information.

All such information must be treated as strictly confidential.

Interns shall not:

- Disclose confidential information to unauthorized persons.
- Photograph or record client information without authorization.
- Copy, download, forward, or share confidential records without authorization.
- Discuss identifiable client information outside authorized professional settings.
- Use organizational or client information for personal, academic, social media, or other purposes without prior authorization.
- Retain confidential information after completion of the internship unless specifically authorized.

The obligation of confidentiality continues after the completion or termination of the internship.

Any breach of confidentiality may result in immediate discontinuation of the internship and may lead to further action as considered appropriate by the organization.

14. USE OF ORGANIZATIONAL INFORMATION AND MATERIALS

All documents, records, formats, internal processes, materials, data, and other information provided to interns for the purpose of their internship shall be used only for authorized internship-related activities.

Interns shall not reproduce, distribute, publish, or share organizational materials without prior authorization.

Any academic work, presentation, report, research, or other material prepared using organizational or client-related information must comply with confidentiality requirements and any specific instructions provided by the organization.

15. PERFORMANCE ASSESSMENT

Intern performance will be assessed throughout the internship based on objective professional and work-related criteria.

The assessment may include:

- Attendance and punctuality.
- Professional behaviour.
- Conduct towards clients and staff.
- Communication and interpersonal skills.
- Ability to complete assigned responsibilities.
- Quality and accuracy of work.
- Structure, clarity, and accuracy of documentation.
- Timely submission of assigned reports.
- Compliance with reporting requirements.
- Ability to follow instructions.
- Ability to incorporate feedback.
- Initiative within the scope of assigned responsibilities.
- Ability to work effectively with the team.
- Overall professional development demonstrated during the internship.

15.1 Final Assessment

Where applicable, the final assessment will include:

1. **Final Report** – Evaluation of the structure, clarity, content, accuracy, completeness, and submission discipline of the report.
2. **Final Presentation** – Presentation of a topic or topics assigned by the Internship Supervisor relating to the intern's area of study, psychology, social work, mental health, or other relevant professional subjects.
3. **Overall Performance** – Evaluation of attendance, punctuality, professional conduct, behaviour towards staff and clients, documentation, task completion, responsiveness to supervision, and overall performance during the internship.

The final report and presentation, together with the intern's overall performance throughout the internship, will form the basis of the final internship assessment.

16. FEEDBACK AND PERFORMANCE REVIEW

Interns may receive feedback from the Internship Supervisor or other designated members of the organization during the internship.

Where performance does not meet the expected standard, the organization may:

- Provide corrective feedback.
- Clarify expected standards.
- Provide additional supervision.
- Modify assigned responsibilities.
- Reduce the level of independent responsibility.
- Review the intern's continuation in the programme.

17. CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION

A Certificate of Completion may be issued upon satisfactory completion of the internship, subject to the organization's assessment.

Issuance of the certificate will be subject to:

- Completion of the prescribed internship period.
- Satisfactory attendance and punctuality.
- Compliance with professional conduct requirements.

- Completion of assigned responsibilities.
- Timely submission of required reports and documentation.
- Completion of the required final report, where applicable.
- Completion of the required final presentation, where applicable.
- Satisfactory overall performance evaluation.
- Compliance with confidentiality and organizational requirements.

The organization reserves the right to withhold the Certificate of Completion where the intern has not satisfactorily fulfilled the internship requirements.

Completion of an internship does not guarantee employment, consultancy, or any future engagement with BSmile The Mind Studio.

18. STIPEND

Where applicable, BSmile The Mind Studio may provide a stipend to an intern based on the organization's applicable internship provisions.

The eligibility, amount, and payment of any stipend will be determined by the organization based on the intern's performance and the applicable terms communicated for the respective internship programme.

A stipend, where provided, shall not be considered a salary or employment compensation unless otherwise expressly stated by the organization.

19. TERMINATION OR DISCONTINUATION OF INTERNSHIP

BSmile The Mind Studio reserves the right to discontinue an internship before the scheduled completion date in cases including, but not limited to:

- Serious misconduct.
- Breach of confidentiality.
- Repeated unapproved absence.
- Persistent punctuality issues.
- Harassment or inappropriate behaviour.

- Failure to follow reasonable instructions.
- Failure to comply with organizational policies.
- Misuse of confidential or organizational information.
- Conduct that adversely affects clients, staff, or the organization.
- Failure to maintain required professional standards.
- Unsatisfactory performance.
- Any other conduct considered inconsistent with the requirements of the internship.

In cases involving serious misconduct, confidentiality breaches, harassment, or other significant violations, the organization may discontinue the internship with immediate effect.

20. DOCUMENTS REQUIRED BEFORE COMMENCEMENT

Depending on the nature and requirements of the internship, the organization may require interns to submit relevant documents before commencement, including:

- Copy of Aadhaar Card or other valid identification.
- Permission or recommendation letter from the concerned educational institution, where applicable.
- College or university identification card, where applicable.
- Internship-related documentation prescribed by the educational institution.
- Any other documents reasonably required by the organization.

Where applicable, an internship registration fee may be charged. The amount and payment requirements will be communicated to the intern before commencement.

21. ORGANIZATIONAL DISCRETION

BSmile The Mind Studio reserves the right to determine:

- The number of interns accepted.
- Internship eligibility requirements.
- Internship duration.
- Assigned responsibilities.

- Level of supervision.
- Attendance requirements.
- Performance standards.
- Assessment methods.
- Certificate eligibility.
- Stipend eligibility, where applicable.
- Continuation or discontinuation of the internship.

The organization may modify internship responsibilities or procedures based on operational, professional, or organizational requirements.

22. POLICY COMPLIANCE

All interns are required to comply with this Internship Policy and any other applicable organizational policies, procedures, instructions, and professional standards communicated during the internship.

Failure to comply with the requirements of this policy may result in corrective action, modification of responsibilities, withholding of the Certificate of Completion, or discontinuation of the internship, depending on the nature and severity of the matter.

23. POLICY REVIEW AND AMENDMENT

BSmile The Mind Studio reserves the right to review, modify, update, or replace this policy as required based on organizational requirements, operational changes, professional standards, or applicable regulations.

Any revised version of the policy shall supersede the previous version from its stated effective date.

24. POLICY AUTHORITY

This policy is issued under the authority of **BSmile The Mind Studio** and shall serve as the standard Internship Policy applicable to interns engaged by the organization.

Specific internship programmes may include additional requirements based on the intern's academic discipline, role, or institutional requirements. Such requirements shall supplement this policy and shall not automatically replace the provisions contained herein.



Because Every Mind Deserves a Smile



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